



COWORK OS GUIDE

Good Practices

Guide

Practical wisdom for getting the most from your system over time

Working with Sessions

Start a new session when: *Switching tasks, system feels sluggish, updated About Me, or finished major work.*

Continue when: *Iterating on work, need earlier context, or doing multi-step related work.*

Rule of thumb: *New task, new session. Context is free and sessions reset cleanly.*

STRATEGY

Structuring Complex Requests

Give Claude three things: **what you want** (the deliverable), **why it matters** (the context), and **what good looks like** (your success criteria).

For big tasks: *Ask Claude to make a plan first. This costs nothing, prevents rework, and gives you confidence.*

LEVERAGE

Memory

Memory files let CoWork OS learn how you work. Update them after significant sessions so the system remembers your preferences, decisions, and context.

Log These:

Key decisions, discovered preferences, system changes, important context

Skip These:

Routine completions, minor tweaks, obvious iterations, one-off tasks

After big sessions: *Prompt Claude to update memory. It takes 30 seconds and makes everything smarter next time.*

SPEED

Voice Input — Talk More, Type Less

Voice gets context out of your head faster than you can type. Claude does its best work when you give it enough to work with — and rambling at it for 60 seconds beats spending 5 minutes structuring the perfect prompt.

The pick: Wispr Flow. *System-wide dictation that runs in any text field, transcribes accurately, and cleans up filler words. ~\$12/month. Pays for itself the first day.* wisprflow.ai

REFINEMENT

The Art of Feedback

Specific feedback beats vague. Instead of "this isn't right," show Claude what's wrong and what you want instead.

If you give the same correction twice: Add it to your writing rules or voice profile so it becomes permanent.

TOOLS

Working with Skills and Plugins

Installing skills: Click "Copy to your skills" in any skill card. Find .skill files in [RESOURCES/MY SKILLS/](#).

Triggering skills: Use natural language: "Set up my system," "Review my system," "First week guide."

Skills vs plugins: *Skills handle specific tasks. Plugins handle entire domains. Both live in your system; use what fits your moment.*

ORGANIZATION

File Hygiene

ABOUT ME/

Update when meaningful changes happen. This is where CoWork OS learns how you work.

CLAUDE.md

Keep lean. This is your global instruction—edit sparingly, keep it tight.

WORK AREAS/

Project folders stay organised. Leave them after completion — they're reference, not clutter.

TEMPLATES/

Build when you spot patterns. Reusable structures compound over time.

KNOWLEDGE/

Your local second brain. Drop sources into RAW, ask questions, get permanent reports. See the Knowledge Base Guide in [RESOURCES/GUIDES/](#).

Outputs/ (per area)

Where Claude saves your work. Each project has its own; the area-level one is for one-off deliverables.

How CoWork OS Works Day to Day

At session start: CoWork OS reads About Me to understand who you are, what you like, and what you've decided.

On project pickup: It reads your project folder to understand context, history, and what you've already explored.

The pattern: *Read → remember → work smarter. This is why keeping memory and context current matters.*

UNBLOCK

When Claude Gets Stuck

1. **Rephrase:** Use different words. Sometimes the phrasing matters.
2. **Break down:** Split the problem into smaller pieces. Ask for the plan first.
3. **Fresh session:** Start new. Context resets let Claude approach with fresh eyes.
4. **More context:** Paste in the actual file, the full requirements, the example that matters.
5. **Check basics:** Is the file path right? Does the tool actually exist? Is the format correct?

REALITY

What CoWork OS Can and Can't Do

CoWork OS creates, not sends. Claude drafts emails, posts, and messages — you always review before they go live.

It works within your folder system. CoWork OS can read, organise, and manage files in your defined structure. It's a partner to your system, not a replacement.

Tasks That Run Outside Your Session

Two situations where actions happen *outside* your active CoWork conversation — and the silent failures that catch people out.

Scheduled tasks

The Claude app must be open. If the app is closed at the scheduled time, the task is skipped silently. Keep the app running in the background.

Scheduled tasks open a fresh session that does NOT inherit your CoWork folder. The new session has no folder context — it doesn't know about your About Me files, memory, or where files live. Relative paths fail silently.

Two habits make every scheduled task reliable:

1. **Absolute paths everywhere** — `/Users/[you]/Claude CoWork/WORK AREAS/Admin-PA/tasks.md`, not `WORK AREAS/Admin-PA/tasks.md`.
2. **Open with a folder-context line** — *"Your working folder is /Users/[you]/Claude CoWork/. Read CLAUDE.md and ABOUT ME/ first."*

Dispatch (mobile → desktop)

Dispatched messages land in whatever Claude session is open on desktop — which may not be your CoWork session. So your identity, memory, and workspace context don't apply.

Two ways to fix it: (1) Open your CoWork folder as a favourite Project on desktop Claude, and dispatch into it. (2) Include *"use my CoWork folder at /Users/[you]/Claude CoWork/"* in the dispatched message itself.

Making It Yours

CoWork OS is a foundation, not a prescription. Make it yours as you learn what works.

- **Update as you go:** Add preferences to voice profile. Build writing rules when you spot patterns in feedback.
- **Build templates:** Found a structure that works? Save it. Reuse compounds over time.
- **Create specialists:** A plugin for video research? A skill for LinkedIn drafts? Build them when you see the gap.
- **Run System Review monthly:** Take 15 minutes to clean up, update memory, and prune what's not working.

Systems Made Better

CoWork OS is part of the Better Creating ecosystem — tools, templates, and training for non-technical people building with AI. Visit bettercreating.com for the Agentic Business Accelerator, free skills, system updates, and more.

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